Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A J 9 4
♥ A K Q J 10
♦ A
♣ A K 5

♠ 7
♥ 9 6 4
♦ K 8 6 3
♣ J 10 8 6 2

♠ Q 10 8 5 3 2
♥ 7 3
♦ Q J 10
♣ 9 4

♠ K 6
♥ 8 5 2
♦ 9 7 5 4 2
♣ Q 7 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♥	Pass	3♥
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

6♥ by North
Lead: ♦Q

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♦Q, you signaled with the ♦8 and North won the ♦A.

North then played low to dummy's ♠K, and led dummy's ♠6. Your decision is not whether to play high or low, but whether to ruff or not, which amounts to the same thing.

Do not ruff.

Even though North holds the ♠A, if you ruff now he will just put on a small ♠ and you will be ruffing a loser. Instead discard a ♦.

North will win the ♠A, but will not be able to ruff any ♠ losers in dummy because your trumps can overruff any of South's trumps.

Suppose you had ruffed the ♠. North would have played his ♠9, leaving himself with ♠ A J. He would then get the lead and pull your two remaining trumps. That would leave one trump in dummy to ruff his ♠J, his only remaining loser.

Board 2
South Deals
None Vul

♠ J 6 3
♥ A K 10 9 8
♦ 8 2
♣ 10 9 4

♠ Q 9 2
♥ Q 3
♦ Q J 10 6
♣ K Q J 8

♠ A 10 7 4
♥ J 6 5 2
♦ 9 5 4
♣ 5 3

♠ K 8 5
♥ 7 4
♦ A K 7 3
♣ A 7 6 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♦
Pass	1♥	Pass	1NT
All Pass			

1NT by South
Lead: ♣K

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♣K and continue with the ♣J then ♣Q, taken by South's ♣A. To trick 4 South plays the ♥4. What do you play?

Play the ♥Q.

To see why you should play the ♥Q, just visualize the result if you play low. South will finesse with dummy's ♥8. If East wins his ♥J on this trick there will be 4 good ♥ tricks in dummy. If East withholds his ♥J then Declarer will have 3 ♥ winners.

Now visualize the result of playing the ♥Q. Whether South takes this trick or not he cannot win more than 2 ♥s.

Board 3
North Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ A J 2 ♥ K Q 4 ♦ K Q 7 5 ♣ Q 7 2	
♠ 10 8 4 3 ♥ J 5 2 ♦ 10 4 ♣ K 10 8 6	N W E S	♠ 9 7 6 ♥ 10 9 8 7 ♦ J 9 6 3 ♣ 9 5
	♠ K Q 5 ♥ A 6 3 ♦ A 8 2 ♣ A J 4 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			

6NT by North
Lead: ♥10

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥10, won by dummy's ♥A. At trick 2 North calls for dummy's ♣3.

Play the ♣6.

You would not have been expecting North to play a small ♣ from dummy's holding. The only way it makes sense is if North holds the ♣Q.

If you play your ♣K you will win the trick, but in so doing you will set up 3 ♣ tricks for North, which is all he needs to make the slam.

Play low instead and North will win his ♣Q. But now your ♣ K 10 sits behind dummy's ♣ J 4 so he can get only one more trick in the suit, the ♣A.

Board 4
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ K 7 2 ♥ K J 10 9 3 ♦ 7 2 ♣ K J 10	
♠ J 10 9 6 ♥ — ♦ 10 8 6 4 3 ♣ A 8 4 3	N W E S	♠ 8 4 3 ♥ 7 4 ♦ Q J 9 5 ♣ Q 9 7 5
	♠ A Q 5 ♥ A Q 8 6 5 2 ♦ A K ♣ 6 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♣[2]	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 0 or 4 aces

6♥ by South
Lead: ♠J

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♠J, the ♠K is played from dummy and holds the trick. Next come dummy's ♥K, then another trump to South's ♥A.

At trick 4 South plays the ♣2 from his hand and you must decide what to play.

Play the ♣3 (smoothly).

South has 2 small ♣s and faces a choice of dummy plays in the suit. He must decide whether to play you for the ♣A or the ♣Q. If you play your ♣A you make the decision very easy for him.

When you correctly play your small ♣ life becomes harder for South. Sometimes he will guess correctly and play dummy's ♣K, but other times he will play dummy's ♣J, hoping you have the ♣Q.

Board 5
North Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ K Q J ♥ A K 7 3 ♦ Q 10 9 4 ♣ 7 3	
♠ A 9 3 ♥ Q 9 8 ♦ A 7 3 ♣ 10 8 5 4	N W E S	♠ 10 8 7 6 2 ♥ 10 5 4 ♦ K 6 ♣ J 9 6
	♠ 5 4 ♥ J 6 2 ♦ J 8 5 2 ♣ A K Q 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by North
Lead: ♠6

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♠6. You won the ♠A and returned the ♠9, won by North's ♠Q.

North next played to dummy's ♣A and led the ♦2. What do you play?

Play the ♦A.

Count the points. North's 15-17 plus South's 11 plus your 10 comes to 36-38. So East has room for an Ace or a King, but no more.

East's second ♠ play was the 2, so it looks like he started with 5 ♠s. And the fall of North's ♠s looks like he may have 1 ♠ left, very likely the ♠K.

All this means that you should take your ♦A now and return your last ♠ to establish East's suit. Now East's ♦K will be an entry to the ♠s

If you play low, East will have to take the ♦K now, and although he can play a ♠ to establish the suit, he will not have an entry to be able to cash them.